THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

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CLASS 8 — SOCIAL SCIENCE · HARD LEVEL UNIT TEST SET 2

Chapters 2–4: **Reshaping India's Political Map, The Rise of the Marathas, The Colonial Era in India** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 2 Hours Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 50**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–15 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 16–20 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 21–25 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 26–27 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 24–25 and Q. 26–27.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 15 × 1 = 15

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. The fall of Hampi illustrates that 1

(a) rivers protect
(b) trade is useless
(c) forts are strong always
(d) a rich city can be destroyed after a single defeat

2. If a coastal fort resists European and Mughal ships, it shows 1

(a) strong sea defence **(b)** trade
(c) neglect **(d)** peace

3. A tax collector demands full payment despite a failed harvest. The likely result is 1

(a) debt, hunger and unrest **(b)** surplus
(c) peace **(d)** rich farmers

4. A traveller praises Hampi as a city 'as large as Rome'. This evidence best shows 1

(a) wealth and size of Vijayanagara **(b)** its small size
(c) its weakness **(d)** its foreign rule

5. A force raids a camp at night and vanishes before dawn. This is typical of 1

(a) guerrilla warfare **(b)** siege
(c) formal battle **(d)** naval war

6. A treaty makes a ruler pay for British troops stationed in his kingdom. This is the 1

(a) Cartaz **(b)** Doctrine of Lapse
(c) Dewani **(d)** Subsidiary Alliance

7. The Khalsa initiation with five Ks created 1

(a) a trade guild **(b)** a tax office
(c) a university **(d)** unity and discipline in the community

8. Which is a reasonable inference from Shivaji's escape from Agra? 1

(a) He lost support **(b)** He had no plan
(c) He loved Aurangzeb **(d)** He could think and plan under pressure

9. Dupleix's use of sepoys influenced the British because 1

(a) they banned it **(b)** they joined France
(c) they adopted the practice **(d)** they ignored it

10. Both Rani Durgavati and Lachit Borphukan are remembered for 1

(a) writing history **(b)** trading in horses
(c) joining Akbar **(d)** resisting a stronger Mughal army

11. A letter from a Maratha chief asks the Peshwa for orders; it shows 1

(a) no central power **(b)** authority of the Peshwa
(c) Mughal rule **(d)** British rule

12. Why might Macaulay's policy be called unequal? 1

(a) It banned English
(b) It taught all equally
(c) It privileged English over Indian languages
(d) It supported villages

13. **Assertion (A):** Akbar abolished the jizya tax on non-Muslims. 1
Reason (R): Akbar became emperor at the age of 13.
Choose the correct option:
(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

14. **Assertion (A):** Chauth was a tax equal to one-fourth of the revenue. 1
Reason (R): Sardeshmukhi was an extra levy of 10 per cent.
Choose the correct option:
(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

15. **Assertion (A):** After the Battle of Plassey (1757), Mir Jafar became the Nawab of Bengal. 1
Reason (R): Mir Jafar had conspired with Clive against Siraj-ud-daulah.
Choose the correct option:
(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) 5 × 2 = 10

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

16. Why do historians check sources by European officers carefully? 2

17. Why did the Mughals use mansabs rather than hereditary jagirs? 2

18. What does Tarabai's role show about the Marathas? 2

19. Why did peasants fear indigo cultivation? 2

20. Why would a historian doubt a court chronicle's praise of its king? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 5 × 3 = 15

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

21. Case: Traders are protected at sea by naval patrols. Explain the benefits to the economy. 3

22. Argue why village councils' decline hurt Indian society. 3

23. Source: 'Hampi is as large as Rome and the best provided of all cities.' Who wrote this kind of account and what is its value? 3

24. Case: A ruler pays soldiers regularly and moves officials every few years. Identify the ruler and the aim. 3

OR

Case: A ruler without a son adopts an heir and dies; the British annex his state. Identify the policy and an example. 3

25. Argue whether Aurangzeb's policies were the main cause of the Mughal decline. 3

OR

Interpret: 'The Maratha navy challenged the cartaz system.' What does it show? 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

26. **Case study.** At Pratapgad, Shivaji met the Bijapur general Afzal Khan, who had come to subdue him. Shivaji killed him using a concealed steel weapon. Later his soldiers attacked Shaista Khan's camp at Pune at night, and Shivaji raided the rich Mughal port of Surat. 5

(i) Name the weapon used against Afzal Khan.

(ii) At the foot of which fort did the meeting take place?

(iii) Which Mughal port was raided?

(iv) Why did guerrilla tactics suit the Marathas against the Mughals?

27. Analyse the factors that explain the rise of Mughal power under Babur and Akbar. 5

OR

Analyse the factors that enabled a small kingdom to challenge the Mughal Empire. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 50 Marks

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